

HS 358: Science Writing

Course Code	HS 358
Course Name	Science Writing
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	None
Intended for	UG
Distribution	Elective for all
Approval	9th Senate (May 2016)

Course Contents

- **Introductions** Class overview- Writing for a general audience- Zinsser, William. Science, Technology and Nature. Chapter 15 in On Writing Well: The Classic Guide to Writing Nonfiction. 30th Anniversary ed. Harper Perennial, 2006, pp. 14764. ISBN: 9780060891541. [4 Lectures]
- **The pleasures and challenges of science writing** The science essay- Introduce Essay1 Lightman, Alan. The Accidental Universe. Harper's, December 2011. [4 Lectures]
- **Description** Accuracy + making it fresh- A writer's voice From Devils to Mathematics. Example student work. [2 Lectures]
- **WORKSHOP** Essay 1 (full class and small groups) [EH] Chapter 1, and skim chapter 2 ALSO, Select book for Book Review. [3 Lectures]
- **Return essays** What do we mean by revision?-Discuss News and Profile article assignments- Short News Articles on Science-Read several articles from different disciplines on ScienceNews.org [5 Lectures]
- **The profile** Writing about science by writing about scientists Brainstorm Profile/Archive assignment ideas, incl. background reading-Issues re: News stories? -Burgos, Ana. A Professor of Puzzles. Angels, 2012. [5 Lectures]
- **Complex issues** Getting readers to think like scientists-The research process: Why we cite. [4 Lectures]
- **aking a stand** Writing to persuade-The research process: Note-taking-Discuss Research proposals [4 Lectures]
- **The research process** Citing, quoting, paraphrasing-Writing and Structure (Hancock and handouts)-Organizing a longer article. [4 Lectures]
- **Revision issues** Discussion of favourite science writing -The Book Review: an important genre. [4 Lectures]
- **WORKSHOP Book Reviews** 1 full class, & small groups - Share best writing-Summing up & reflecting-Evaluations-All work due . [3 Lectures]

References

1. Elizabeth, Royte., **Fracking Our Food Supply**, The Nation, November 2012.
2. Hancock, Elise., **Ideas into Words: Mastering the Craft of Science Writing**, The Johns Hopkins University Press, 2003. ISBN: 9780801873300.
3. Kanigel, Robert., **The Science Essay**, Chapter 22 in A Field Guide for Science Writers: The Official Guide of the National Association of Science Writers. 2nd ed. Edited by Deborah, Mary Knudson, and Robin Marantz Henig. Oxford University Press, 2005, pp. 14550. ISBN: 9780195174991.
4. Pollan, Michael., **Our Decrepit Food Factories**, The New York Times Magazine, December 16, 2007.
5. Quammen, David., **Deadly Contact**, National Geographic, October 2007.
6. Steingraber, Sandra., **The Whole Fracking Enchilada**, Orion, September/October 2010. Zinsser, William. On Writing Well: The Classic Guide to Writing Nonfiction. 30th Anniversary ed. Harper Perennial, 2006, pp. 14764. ISBN: 9780060891541. <http://www.ScienceNews.org>